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EQUIPMENT BAG ATTACHMENT APPARATUS AND METHOD

Abstract

The present invention relates to a method and apparatus for releasably securing items to a bag, and in particular to a method and apparatus for securing equipment, covers, articles, devices, and the like to a sports bag such as a golf bag using magnetic adhesion.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application claims priority to and incorporates by reference U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/560,322 filed on Mar. 1, 2024.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

[0002] The present invention relates to a method and apparatus for releasably securing items to a bag, and in particular to a method and apparatus for securing equipment, covers, articles, devices and the like to a sports bag such as a golf bag, however, a person of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the invention is not necessarily so limited.

Background

[0003] In many areas of life, and in particular in sports, items stored in bags or adjacent thereto need to be removed and replaced on a repeated basis. For example, in sports such as golf a number of items are stored in or adjacent to a golf bag. These include, covers for clubs such as drivers, fairway woods, putters, and other clubs, towels, clothing, equipment covers, as well as other items.

[0004] These items are frequently removed from bags/clubs for short periods of times and then put back in place. For example, when a golf club is selected for use, it is removed from the bag, and if the club has a head cover then the cover is removed. The club is then used, and put back in the bag, and hopefully the golfer remembers to replace the head cover.

[0005] Countless items such as head covers are lost, misplaced, overlooked, or forgotten as a result of this process. This is a constant source of frustration to golfers.

[0006] Several prior art methods have been used to address this problem, but they suffer from a number of drawbacks. Golf carts often have baskets where items can be placed, but they can still be forgotten or lost, and not everyone uses a golf cart. Strings have been used to secure head covers to each other. The strings do not secure the covers to the bag. Also, strings get tangled, break, and interfere with the removal of the clubs from the bags. Hook and loop fasteners such as Velcro™ have been used, however, the fasteners can be atheistically unpleasing, can mar surfaces, collect dirt, and eventually wear out and lose adhesion.

[0007] Thus, a need exists for method and apparatus to provide a secure and efficient way to secure items to a bag.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0008] FIG. 1 shows a golf bag and head cover of the present invention.

[0009] FIG. 2 shows a head cover and putter cover of the present invention.

[0010] FIG. 3 shows a clip and magnetic disk of the present invention.

[0011] FIG. 4 shows a golf bag and head cover of the present invention.

[0012] FIG. 5 shows a head cover and putter cover of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

[0013] In the Figures, a method and apparatus for securing items to a bag is shown. In one embodiment that invention relates to securing golf club head covers **12** to a golf bag **10**, however, the invention is not necessarily limited thereto.

[0014] FIG. 1 shows a golf bag **10** of the present invention, which includes a magnetic area **14** on the outside surface of the bag **10**, which can be applied to the surface of the bag **10** or built in at the time of manufacture. In FIG. 1, the magnetic area **14** is located in the shaded region near the handle or the bag **10**, adjacent to the top of the bag **10** where the clubs are stored. The magnetic area **14** can be located in other locations such as the sides of the bag **10**. Also, the bag **10** can include multiple magnetic areas **14** of varied sizes and shapes as best oriented to accomplish the purpose of the present invention.

[0015] Also, FIG. 1 shows a golf club head cover **12** that includes a metal magnetic disk **16** applied to the surface of the cover **12**. The magnetic disk **16** can be placed in different orientations or locations on the head cover **12**, or multiple magnetic disks **16** can be used on a single head cover

12. The magnetic disk **16** can be applied to an existing head cover **12**, through tape, glue, adhesives backing/strips. In this manner, an existing head cover **12** can be modified to be usable with the present invention. The head cover **12** can then magnetically secure to the magnetic area **14** on the golf bag **10**.

[0016] Alternatively, as shown in FIG. 2, the head cover **12** can be originally constructed with the magnetic disk **16** embedded into the head cover **12**, either under the surface, along the seams of the head cover, or in any other convenient manner. Similarly, the magnetic area **14** on the golf bag **10** can be built into the bag **10** during its original construction, or existing bags **10** can be modified. FIG. 2 shows a putter cover **18** with a magnetic disk **16** included therein, which functions in the same manner and serves the same purpose as the head cover **12**.

[0017] FIG. 3 shows a kit that can be used to modify existing golf bags **10**, and club head covers **12**. A magnetic bar **20** includes on a clip **18** is provided that can be secured to the bag **10** at any convenient location, and magnetic disks **16** can be secured to the head covers **12** as described above. The magnetic bar **20** and clip **18** can be secured to a golf bag **10** in other manners, such as with screws, pins, carabineer clips, and the like.

[0018] FIG. 4 shows a bag **10** with an expanded magnetic area **14**, which can include the collar **20** and/or the handle **22** of the golf bag **10**. As mentioned, the magnetic area **14** can be located in other areas of the golf bag **10**, or there can be multiple magnetic areas **14**.

[0019] FIG. 5 shows a head cover **12** and a putter cover **18** with an expanded magnetic area **24**. Instead of using a magnetic disk **16**, the fabric or material of the head cover **12** or putter cover **18** can be constructed from a magnetic fabric or material.

[0020] In practice, a golfer can remove a head cover prior to their shot and place the head cover on the magnetic area securing the head cover during the shot. After completing play, the head cover can then be placed back on the club and put in the bag, however, if the golfer forgets to do so the head cover will remain attached to the bag until put back on the club. Thus, the head cover is not left behind or separated from the golf bag because it is attached thereto. In this manner, the present invention solves the problems associated with the prior art.

[0021] Additionally, securement of the head cover to the golf bag can be achieved by embedding it in or on the head cover with any plate, disc, clip, or other device that is either magnetic itself, or that is made of ferromagnetic material which is attractive to a magnet placed on the bag or elsewhere in close proximity of the head cover. Further, that head covers can secure in an analogous manner to each other. Head covers can contain a magnet and a device that is attractive to a magnet, such that one head cover can attach to another.

[0022] The present invention has application beyond the embodiments described herein. For example, other items can be secured to the magnetic area by placing a magnetic disk in them such as a towel, ball markers, divot repair tools, range finder bag, a scorecard, or a small bag containing tees and the like. The invention has application to other types of sports, or bags as well. Further, the invention can be used with equipment bags in sports such as tennis, disc golf, hockey, basketball, football, track and field, and other sports; and the invention could be used outside of sports such as with backpacks for school or travel, purses, tool belts, briefcases, luggage, and the like. Still further, the orientation of the magnet and the attractive area can be reversed, where the magnet is on either the bag or the head cover.

[0023] Unless otherwise defined, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this invention belongs. Although methods and materials like or equivalent to those described herein can be used in the practice or testing of the present invention, suitable methods, and materials are described below. All publications, patent applications, patents, and other references mentioned herein are incorporated by reference in their entirety to the extent allowed by applicable law and regulations. In case of conflict, the present specification, including definitions, will control.

[0024] The present invention may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from the

spirit or essential attributes thereof, and it is therefore desired that the present embodiment be considered in all respects as illustrative and not restrictive, reference being made to the appended claims rather than to the foregoing description to indicate the scope of the invention. Those of ordinary skill in the art that have the disclosure before them will be able to make modifications and variations therein without departing from the scope of the invention.

Claims

1. An article comprising: a bag having a magnetic area; and a cover having an area attractive to a magnetic whereby the cover and be releasably secured to the bag.
 2. The article of claim 1 where the bag is a golf bag, and the cover is a head cover.
 3. The article of claim 2 where the magnetic area is located near a top of the golf bag adjacent to the head covers.
 4. The article of claim 2 where the area attractive to a magnetic is a disk.
 5. The article of claim 4 where the disk is attached to the head cover after manufacture.
 6. The article of claim 4 where the disk is embedded into the head cover at the time of manufacture.
 7. The article of claim 1 where the area attractive to the magnet is made from a fabric attractive to a magnet.
 8. The article of claim 1 where the magnetic area on the bag is a clip secured to the bag.
 9. The article of claim 1 where the area attractive to a magnetic is a disk secured to the head cover with an adhesive.
 10. The article of claim 1 further comprising multiple magnetic areas on the bag.
 11. The article of claim 1 where the magnetic are comprises a collar and a handle of the bag.
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